international and we should not, I do not think we should be reluctant at all to stimulate the use of international leverage to solve some of these problems.

But I think those would be the two points that I would make.

Chairman Berman. Mr. Royce is recognized for 5 minutes.

Mr. Royce. Thank you, Mr. Chairman.

Two of the main criticisms that we heard laid out is that the administration does not have a master plan for the Tribal Regions and that the approach there has primarily been military. But it is worth noting we have killed several hundred militants with this approach; that is one plus. But as we look at the development aid into the Northwest Frontier, and I was in the Northwest Frontier last year, I find it a little difficult to just going off the basis of what I have seen with development aid elsewhere in the world to assume that it is going to create the desired effects there. You have illiteracy running at 90 percent.

The GAO, you know, raised the argument that the administration does not have a plan but the GAO would not go into that region because of the security concerns. And I remember a journalist from South Waziristan telling me, ''There is only 2 percent of the people in this room that agree with you so, you know, do not raise any issues like Taliban or al-Qaeda.'' And he said, ''I am that person that happens to agree with you. But I was educated in Britain and everybody else here is not.''

And so with this conundrum I think it is understandable why security would be the first focus. And I would like to know why we should be more optimistic about prospects for us sparking development in these regions based on what we have seen? I hate to sound pessimistic about that but I think we are bringing our mindsets and our structures to Pakistan instead of dealing with it as it is and as I think it is going to continue to be because the rapid transformation of Pakistani society we are seeing is primarily the Talibanization of the country as these madrassahs graduate more and more students.

And also, regardless of what we spend on infrastructure, on health, on governance, on trying to create jobs, I do not think that that is going to be for anything but naught if—and actually some of that may harm our interests in the long term if Pakistan's education continues in the direction it is going. And there is no way we could afford to educate all of Pakistan.

And lastly, this is not just an educational issue, it is not just because that education system is weak. The idea of radicalism that has this power to win adherence in that society is a phenomenon that is growing in the culture.

Lastly, I just wanted to throw out an idea that I think Senator Joe Lieberman has raised which strikes me as a good one with regards to Afghanistan. The Afghan army has the confidence of 90 percent of the people there. Its one problem is it is so small it can only secure the capital. And so, as a consequence the government itself is now in the process, Karzai's government, in making negotiations with warlords in the outside area in order to try to secure some kind of stability, which we do not like to see. But if we paid that army properly it would still be paid at 1⁄70 th the rate of pay of NATO troops or U.S. troops in the theater. And if we built that army up, and what he is suggesting is the concept of an international trust fund, we could get NATO members, we could get European countries to pay into that because they do not want to send additional brigades. But you could have 70 brigades for what it would cost to get another brigade out of Germany over there.

So what about Senator Joe Lieberman's idea about setting up for the future something that would decrease the Karzai's government dependency on any of these warlords and

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